

Education, General

Education Specialist

The program coordinator is dependent upon which department is offering the Ed.S. degree program being sought.

PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

The program offers coursework and research opportunities for:

the Education Specialist (Ed.S.) degree with Class AA Teacher Certification in:

- Collaborative Teaching (K-6)
- Collaborative Teaching (6-12)
- Elementary Education (K-6)
- Family/Consumer Sci (6-12)
- Early Childhood Education (P-3)

the Education Specialist (Ed.S.) degree with Class AA Instructional Support Personnel Certification in:

Instructional Leadership

Certification

All teacher education majors that have met the requirements must apply for Alabama Certification. A candidate who files an application must complete the curriculum approved by the State of Alabama. The completion of the curriculum approved for certification and all other requirements for graduation will qualify the student to apply for a professional educator's certificate. The levels of Alabama Professional Educator Certificates for students in the graduate program are Class A: Master's degree and Class AA: Ed.S. degree.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#). Specific requirements to these programs are –

Class AA

Collaborative Teaching K-6
Collaborative Teaching 6-12
Elementary K-6
Family & Consumer Science 6-12
Early Childhood P-3

In addition to specific course requirements, applicants seeking admission must:

1. Be admitted to Educator Preparation Program. Admission to Educator Preparation Program requires the applicant to:
 - a. Present evidence of having completed a Master's degree from an accredited school with Class A Certification in the same teaching field(s) in which the Ed.S. degree is sought.
 - b. Present transcript(s) showing a Master's degree grade point average of 3.25 or better (4.00 system).

Special Education candidates holding a Class "A" teaching certificate in a field other than Special Education may enter the traditional Ed.S. program but are required to take SPE 500 or SPE 522.

Instructional Leadership, Class AA

This degree is designed for individuals who seek greater preparation for leadership in P-12 schools and/or those who aspire towards pursuing doctoral level studies in educational administration.

1. Be admitted to Teacher Education. Admission to Teacher Education requires the applicant to:
 - a. Present evidence of having completed a master's degree with Class A certification, in the same teaching field in which the Ed.S. degree is sought (except in Special Education), from a regionally accredited institution.
 - b. Present transcript(s) showing a master's degree grade point average of 3.25 or better (4.00 system).

In addition to an earned baccalaureate-level professional Educator Certificate in a teaching field and earned masters'-level Professional Educator Certificate in a teaching field or instructional support area, the applicant shall:

1. Have a minimum of three (3) years of successful teaching experience.
2. Submit an admission portfolio before an interview. The portfolio will contain the following:
 - a. Three (3) letters of recommendation (These must include letters from the applicants' principal or supervisor). Each local superintendent will establish requirements for recommendations from the principal and/or supervisor.
 - b. Completed copy (all forms) of the most recent performance appraisal to include the professional development component, if available.
 - c. Evidence of ability to improve student achievement (give 2 examples).
 - d. Evidence of leadership and management potential, including proof of most recent accomplishments in the area of educational leadership (give 2 examples).
3. Summary of candidates' reasons for pursuing instructional leadership certification.
4. Summary of what the candidate expects from the preparation program.
5. Qualify for program admission by successfully completing an interview conducted by a program admission committee that includes both P-12 instructional leaders and higher education faculty.
6. The candidate will also be required to take and pass a writing assessment.

In order to be admitted to the AA program in Instructional Leadership candidates must meet one of the following four (4) criteria:

1. Hold a Class A Instructional Leadership certificate earned after completing a redesigned program at an Alabama university.
2. Be currently serving as a superintendent, assistant or associate superintendent, assistant to the superintendent,